

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Defensive Operations, Threat Hunting and Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with more than five years of experience in defensive security operations, advanced threat hunting, and end-to-end incident response. My career has been built on hands-on work across the full incident response lifecycle - from initial detection and root cause analysis through to containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned - working within large, complex environments of 8,000 or more users. I have deep, practical expertise with Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management) including Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rule development, detection logic authoring, and workbook design, alongside Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR). I regularly execute proactive threat hunts grounded in threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, converting findings into new detection rules and tuning recommendations to close coverage gaps. I have experience overseeing Managed Detection and Response (MDR) and Managed Security Service Provider (MSSP) escalation quality, participating in joint detection-tuning sessions, and developing and refining incident response playbooks and runbooks. I hold a strong understanding of attacker tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs), and I am equally comfortable translating complex technical findings to senior stakeholders as I am working at the command line. I am now seeking a senior defensive operations role where I can continue driving intelligence-led security at organisational scale.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, workbooks, watchlists), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **Threat Hunting and Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, hypothesis-driven hunting, detection rule development, tuning recommendations
- **Incident Response (IR):** Full IR lifecycle per NIST 800-61 - detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review; IR playbook and runbook development
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender suite
- **Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR):** Playbook design and automation to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR)
- **MDR/MSSP Oversight:** Escalation quality review, analyst feedback, joint detection-tuning sessions
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Cloud and Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure, Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Email and Perimeter Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Lead defensive security operations across an estate of 8,000+ users, owning the end-to-end incident response lifecycle from initial detection through to post-incident lessons learned and playbook updates, in line with NIST 800-61.
- Author and maintain KQL analytics rules, detection logic, workbooks, and watchlists in Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management), surfacing attacker tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs) mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework and reducing analyst noise through precision tuning.
- Execute proactive threat hunting campaigns grounded in threat intelligence, MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, and past incident learnings, converting hunt findings into actionable detection rules and tuning recommendations to close coverage gaps.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Falcon Prevent, Insight, and Discover, using the platform for threat investigation, endpoint telemetry enrichment, and proactive adversary detection.
- Operate Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) - including Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) - deployed across the full 8,000+ user estate, triaging and resolving complex multi-vector security incidents.
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate containment, notification, and remediation workflows, materially reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common and recurring incident types.
- Oversee MDR/MSSP escalation quality including reviewing analyst output quality, providing structured feedback, and contributing to joint detection-tuning sessions to improve overall service effectiveness.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access and zero-trust principles across privileged accounts and administrative systems.
- Administer Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID including Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) to secure identity at scale.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst

- Triaged, investigated, and resolved security alerts across Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM) and CrowdStrike Falcon, authoring KQL-based threat queries and contributing alert-tuning recommendations to reduce false positive volume and improve detection fidelity.
- Contributed to threat hunting initiatives using MITRE ATT&CK adversary emulation data and open-source threat intelligence feeds, identifying previously undetected activity and raising detection engineering proposals to strengthen analyst coverage.
- Supported full-lifecycle incident response activities - from initial triage and evidence gathering through to containment, eradication, and post-incident reporting - maintaining clear evidence chains and stakeholder communication throughout.
- Delivered vulnerability management across the estate using Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), prioritising remediation by risk rating and tracking remediation to completion.
- Administered Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) identity controls including Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and group-based access policies to enforce the principle of least privilege across the organisation.
- Supported scripting and automation using PowerShell to streamline repetitive security administration and response tasks.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Implemented and maintained security controls, infrastructure hardening measures, and quality assurance processes within a Software as a Service (SaaS) and financial technology (FinTech) environment, protecting data assets in a regulated commercial setting.
- Supported security monitoring, incident triage, and IT infrastructure management across cloud and on-premises systems, contributing to the organisation's overall security posture and operational resilience.
- Assisted with endpoint management and security tool configuration to protect organisational data assets and ensure business continuity.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the full deployment and operationalisation of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000+ user devices at UAL, dramatically improving endpoint visibility, detection capability, and the organisation's ability to respond to advanced threats at scale.
- Engineered a suite of KQL-based detection rules and analytics workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that materially reduced analyst alert fatigue, improved detection coverage against MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, and increased mean time to detect (MTTD) accuracy.
- Designed and operationalised Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that automated containment and notification workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common incident types and freeing analyst capacity for higher-value threat hunting and investigation work.
- Established and maintained a structured threat hunting programme at UAL, producing regular hunt reports with MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, actionable detection recommendations, and measurable improvements to the organisation's detection coverage over time.
- Maintained active CISSP certification, demonstrating broad and deep knowledge across all eight domains of information security including security and risk management, security operations, and software development security.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)